

Week 1 Technical Fixes — Task Sheet

Five tasks, Monday to Wednesday. Full steps are in the email. This sheet is for ticking off, for the proof you send back, and for the hours you bill.

5

TASKS

5 h

ESTIMATED

7 h

HARD CAP

3

DAYS

THE SIX RULES — read before starting

1. Do Task 0, the backup, before anything else. Not optional.
2. Do only what is written. Do not fix anything else you notice.
3. Never deactivate a plugin, edit a code file, or touch Settings > Permalinks.
4. If a setting is not where described: screenshot what you see, send it, move on.
5. Do not start the next day early. Finish, send proof, stop.
6. Hit the cap on a task? Stop, say so, move to the next. You are paid either way.

DAY 1 — MONDAY 1.5 hours · cap 2 h

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 0. Backup DO FIRST	15 min cap 30 min	UpdraftPlus → Backup Now. Tick both database and files. Wait for it to finish.	Screenshot of the completed backup showing today's date.
☐ 1. Fix robots.txt	45 min cap 1 h	Replace the file contents with the block on page 2. Two lines are removed on purpose. First tell me which SEO plugin you found: Yoast, Rank Math, or neither.	Screenshot of marketeersresearch.com/robots.txt showing the new text.
☐ 2. Switch off photo pages and tag pages	30 min cap 45 min	A: switch media/attachment pages off. B: hide tag pages from search. Check A worked: /media/karim/ should show the photo file or a not-found page, never a normal page with our menu.	One screenshot of setting A, one of setting B.

DAY 2 — TUESDAY 2.5 hours · cap 3.5 h

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 3. Remove the date links from blog posts MOST IMPORTANT	2.5 h cap 3.5 h	The7 → Theme Options → Blog → Post Meta → switch Date off. Then clear the WP-Optimize cache <i>and</i> the Sucuri cache. Count matches for <code>/blog/2026/</code> in the page source before and after. Before is usually 1 or 2. After must be 0. This is the one task worth taking your time over.	Two screenshots: the match count before, and the match count after.

DAY 3 — WEDNESDAY 1 hour · cap 1.5 h

Task	Time	What you are doing	Proof to send
☐ 4. Start the image compression RUNS BY ITSELF	1 h cap 1.5 h	Install EWWW Image Optimizer (free, unlimited — not ShortPixel). Media → Bulk Optimize → Start. Then clear both caches and check the speed. The plugin runs on its own for 1–2 hours. Start it, go and do other work, check back every 30 minutes. Do not bill for watching it.	Screenshot of the finished Bulk Optimize screen, plus the LCP number from pagespeed.web.dev.

End of each day: one message with a line per task ("Task 3 — done" or "Task 3 — stuck"), the proof screenshots, the hours you actually spent, and a list of anything you could not find. Send it even if a task is unfinished. Saying you are stuck is more useful than silence.

When to stop and message instead of continuing

If this happens	Do this
The backup fails or errors	Stop everything. Message immediately. Do not start Task 1.
You cannot find Yoast or Rank Math in the menu	Screenshot the left menu, send it, skip to Task 2.
You cannot find "The7" or the Date switch	Screenshot the screen you are on, send it, then finish the check anyway and report what you see.
The date still shows after clearing both caches	Send both screenshots. Do not try anything else. We pick it up next week.
You reach the cap on any task	Stop that task, say so, move to the next one. You are paid for the capped hours.
Anything asks you to edit code or delete a plugin	Stop. That is never part of this week's work.

Coming next week — for planning only, do not start

Task	Estimate
Hide 5 sign-up and form pages from Google	1.5 h
Resize the 5 largest images by hand	1.5 h
Fix 3 broken links and redirects	1.5 h
Speed up the slow blog category pages	1.5 h

Steps arrive on Friday. Listed here only so you can plan around the content calendar.

1 • The new robots.txt — replace everything with this (Task 1)

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /wp-admin/
Allow: /wp-admin/admin-ajax.php
Disallow: /?s=
Disallow: /search/
Disallow: /?trk=
Disallow: /?clients=
Disallow: /?post_type=
Disallow: /?wordfence_logHuman=

Sitemap: https://marketeersresearch.com/wp-sitemap.xml
```

Removed on purpose: the line blocking `/wp-json/` and the line blocking `/sitemap-custom-posts.xml`. Do not put them back. Keep the blank line before Sitemap.

2 • Where the settings live (Task 2)

Part	If we have Yoast SEO	If we have Rank Math
A Photo pages	Yoast SEO → Settings → Advanced → Media pages → set Enable media pages to OFF	Rank Math → General Settings → Links → set Redirect Attachments to ON
B Tag pages	Yoast SEO → Settings → Content types → Categories & tags → Tags → Show Tags in search results? OFF	Rank Math → Titles & Meta → Tags → Robots Meta → Custom → tick No Index

3 • The date-link check (Task 3)

Step	What to do	Expected result
Before	Open a blog post → right-click → View page source → Ctrl+F → type <code>/blog/2026/</code>	1 or 2 matches
Change	The7 → Theme Options → Blog → Post Meta → Date OFF → Save Changes	Saved
Clear	WP-Optimize → Cache → Purge cache. Then Sucuri → Clear cache. Both .	Both cleared
After	Reload the same post with Ctrl+Shift+R → View page source → Ctrl+F → <code>/blog/2026/</code>	0 matches

4 • The speed check (Task 4)

Go to pagespeed.web.dev, choose the **Mobile** tab, and test this address:

```
https://marketeersresearch.com/blog/the-role-of-ai-data-analytics-in-fmcg-growth-a-roadmap-for-revenue-optimization/
```

Find the figure labelled **LCP** or **Largest Contentful Paint**. It was **4.9 seconds** before this work. Anything lower is progress. Under 2.5 seconds is the goal and we will not reach it this week.

5 • Clearing the cache — both, every time

Where	How
WordPress	Left menu → WP-Optimize → Cache → Purge cache
Sucuri firewall	Log in → Clear cache

If you only clear one, the website keeps showing the old version and you will think the fix failed. This is the single most common reason a task looks like it did not work.

6 • Your hours, for the end-of-week invoice

Task	Estimate	Cap	Hours actually spent
0. Backup	15 min	30 min	

Task	Estimate	Cap	Hours actually spent
1. Fix robots.txt	45 min	1 h	
2. Photo pages and tag pages off	30 min	45 min	
3. Remove the date links	2.5 h	3.5 h	
4. Start the image compression	1 h	1.5 h	
TOTAL	5 h	7 h	

Bill the time you actually worked, not the estimate. On Task 4 do not include the time the plugin spends running on its own while you work on something else.